ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter** (First Flight) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 20

SECTION — A — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
1	**(a)** Camusfearna — *In the West Highlands of Scotland*	1
2	**(d)** dog — *His dog Jonnie had died*	1
3	**(d)** Southern Iraq — *The Tigris marshes*	1
4	**(c)** collect and answer his mail — *With his friend*	1
5	**(b)** two Arabs in a sack — *With a note from his friend*	1
6	**(d)** medieval dragon — *Covered in scales of mud*	1

SECTION — B — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
7	**(i)** A very small medieval-style dragon covered in mud scales.	1
	(ii) Soft chocolate-brown velvet fur like that of a mole.	1
	(iii) A month.	1
	(iv) Coated.	1

SECTION — C — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
8	He had lost his dog and did not want another; Camusfearna was ringed by water, so an otter would suit; life without a pet was lonely.	2
9	His friend sent two Arabs with a squirming sack containing an otter from the Tigris marshes along with a note: 'Here is your otter'.	2

SECTION — D — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
10	Aloof on the first day; slept on the bed on the second night; lost apathy; took keen interest; splashed in the bath; opened taps; followed without a lead; played with ball and marbles.	3
	OR: Mij was put in a box one hour earlier; Maxwell found it blood-stained and Mij exhausted after tearing the lining; he removed sharp edges, rushed to the airport, an air hostess helped; Mij leapt out and ran in the aircraft before returning to Maxwell.	3
11	They love water, play with objects, juggle marbles, are curious and clever, affectionate to their owners, and need constant stimulation and freedom.	3
	OR: He played with toys; invented a ping-pong game using a sloping suitcase; walked on a lead; developed compulsive habits like galloping on the school wall; Londoners failed to identify him.	3

Evaluator's note: Answers given are model answers / value points; accept any other relevant and correct response in the candidate's own words. For writing tasks, marks are for format, content, organisation and accuracy of language. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted.

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Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter** (First Flight) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 20

SECTION — A — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
1	**(a)** Mijbil — *Called Mij for short*	1
2	**(b)** it was previously unknown to science and Maxwell found it — *Lutrogale perspicillata maxwelli*	1
3	**(a)** aloof and indifferent — *He slept far from the bed*	1
4	**(c)** bathroom — *He splashed in the bathtub*	1
5	**(b)** Water must be kept on the move — *'Water must be kept on the move'*	1
6	**(d)** marbles — *He rolled them on his belly*	1

SECTION — B — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
7	**(i)** That Maxwell take Mij on his knee.	1
	(ii) She mistook the running otter for a rat.	1
	(iii) He missed and his face got covered in curry.	1
	(iv) She stayed calm and smiling.	1

SECTION — C — Answers — 4 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
8	Mij was aloof and indifferent for a day, slept far away; on the second night he slept on the bed behind Maxwell's knees and later became curious.	2
9	He plunged, rolled and swam, shot up and down underwater and splashed water all over the place.	2

SECTION — D — Answers — 6 Marks

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
10	Baby seal, squirrel, walrus, hippo, beaver, bear cub, leopard, brontosaur; otters are rare in London and Londoners were unfamiliar with them.	3
	OR: Caring, patient, observant, humorous, adventurous; he loved animals and took great trouble to look after his pet.	3
11	The lesson shows Mij's distress in the box and being on a lead; wild animals belong in natural habitats; they suffer in captivity; though Maxwell cared, ethical issues remain.	3
	OR: He dribbled a rubber ball like a footballer, threw it with a flick of the neck, juggled marbles on his belly while lying on his back, played with a terrapin shell and ping-pong ball.	3

Evaluator's note: Answers given are model answers / value points; accept any other relevant and correct response in the candidate's own words. For writing tasks, marks are for format, content, organisation and accuracy of language. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted.